

SEAFOOD · ACHARI

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

Prawns marinated in a pickle-spiced masala, then fried till they catch at the edges. The spoonful of achar — mango, tomato, whatever's open in the fridge — is the trick: it gives the whole thing that tangy, pickly kick. Wonderful with rice and dal, or just rice and a bit of chutney.

from the kitchen of Noor

JHINGA ACHARI FRY

main photo — the finished fry ♦

crisp at the edges, curry leaves and all

side photo ♦

prawns marinating

side photo ♦

sizzling in the pan

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

from the kitchen of Noor

A PLATEFUL OF PRAWNS · QUICK FRY, BIG FLAVOUR

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

PRAWNS & MARINADE

- prawns (jhinga), heads & tails off, washed
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- salt (namak), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania) — a little extra
- cumin powder (jeera)
- kalonji (black seeds)
- cumin seeds (zira)
- a spoon of achar — mango, tomato or mixed-veg

FRYING & FINISHING

- oil, for a hot shallow fry
- a sprig of curry leaves
- chopped coriander leaves, to garnish

Any pickle works — the achar is what makes it "achari." Start with a small spoon and taste.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Prep the prawns.** Remove the heads and tails, then wash well and drain.
- 2 Marinate.** Add ginger-garlic paste, turmeric, chili powder, salt, extra coriander powder and cumin powder. Then the kalonji and cumin seeds.
- 3 The achari touch.** Stir in a spoon of achar. Mix well and let it marinate a while.
- 4 Heat the oil.** Get the oil hot and drop in the curry leaves to crackle.
- 5 Fry the prawns.** Lay them in one by one and fry, turning, until cooked through and catching at the edges.
- 6 Finish.** Garnish with coriander leaves. Serve hot with rice and dal, or rice and chutney.

Amma's note: don't crowd the pan — lay the prawns in one by one so they fry, not steam. And don't overcook; prawns are done the moment they curl and turn opaque.

MORE FROM THIS DISH

side photo ✦

cleaned prawns

side photo ✦

the achari masala

side photo ✦

curry leaves crackling

side photo ✦

plated with rice